

In comparative terms, the shapes feature is a major improvement over any other version of Excel developed by Microsoft, freeing you from the clunky diagrams of the past. This feature supports anti-aliasing, which gives your diagrams the smooth and professional edges you've always dreamed of.

8.3 Formatting Graphic Objects

Unlike its predecessors, Excel 2007 allows you to add all kinds of pictures to your worksheet. All image file extensions are supported, including the Macintosh PICT and WordPerfect Graphics formats! What is so special about it? The fun starts as soon as you add a picture or make a shape. You see a new menu item open up inside the ribbon called **Picture Tools > Format**, which allows you to format the image in ways that will make your colleagues jealous!



You can play around with any setting in the Ribbon

You can play around with the brightness and contrast or make your image greyscale, sepia, or any other colour you want it to be. If you happen to go overboard with these Adjust settings, you can always reset your picture to its original by clicking on Reset Picture.

The Picture Styles option allows you to add various default settings like a frame or a bevel effect, or a shadow, or even adding perspective. What's really fascinating is that you can combine any number of these effects to create an effect to your liking. You can also use Crop to remove unnecessary parts of your image.

Let's try creating the image shown in 5 easy steps...

8.3.1 Click **Insert > Shapes** and choose the smiley under Basic Shapes.